

Chai & Charts

The Financial Buddy's Weekly Wrap

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“Rates on Hold, Chips All In”

Welcome to the very first cup of Chai & Charts — this week, the RBI played it safe, the market didn't, and a hospital chain out-debuted everyone's expectations.

This Week in a Nutshell

- **RBI holds the repo rate at 5.25%**, keeping its neutral stance while flagging West Asia-linked disruption to trade and sentiment — a “wait and watch” verdict that markets took in stride.
- **Sensex and Nifty logged a strong weekly gain**, helped along by crude oil sliding below \$80 a barrel on hopes of a US-Iran diplomatic thaw.
- **Manipal Health Enterprises jumped 11% on its stock market debut**, defying a grey market that had been pricing in a muted listing.
- **Bharti Airtel's Q1 FY27 profit jumped 43%**, powered by rising ARPU and strength in its Homes and enterprise businesses.
- **The government opened the LIC OFS**, offering up to a 6.5% stake worth roughly Rs 31,000 crore at a floor price of Rs 382 a share.
- **Cabinet cleared a Rs 1.9 lakh crore push for semiconductors and mobile manufacturing**, deepening the bet on India's chip ecosystem under Semicon India 2.0.
- **Manufacturing PMI slipped to a near five-year low of 53.5**, a reminder that softer domestic demand is offsetting export strength.
- **Karnataka's Labour Department summoned TCS** over roughly 12,000 planned job cuts, after a union complaint pushed the matter into the open.

Markets This Week

It was a week where the headline number undersold the drama. The Sensex closed at **78,581** and the Nifty at **24,624**, but both benchmarks were up more than 2.5% for the week — Nifty added roughly 617 points, its best weekly showing in a while — as easing crude prices took the edge off inflation worries. The RBI's rate hold on verdict day (August 5) was largely priced in, so the bigger swing factor was oil: Brent's slide below \$80 on US-Iran talk optimism gave cyclicals and rate-sensitive names room to run. Gold held just under its recent highs near Rs 1,43,900 per 10 grams for 24-karat, having touched a fresh peak earlier in the week on a weaker dollar, while the rupee stayed rangebound between roughly 94.9 and 95.8 to the dollar, settling near 95.16. It wasn't a

one-way week, though — a new closing auction mechanism and the LIC stake sale briefly knocked indices off their rally on Tuesday before buyers stepped back in.

Cheers, Fears & Jeers

Cheers

Nykaa's Q1 FY27 net profit tripled to Rs 79.76 crore, riding beauty and fashion GMV growth and quick-commerce expansion — a rare quarter where a new-age consumer name delivered on both revenue and margin.

Fears

Manufacturing PMI cooling to its weakest reading since 2021, paired with TCS's 12,000-odd job cuts drawing state government scrutiny, points to a labour market and factory floor that are both losing a step even as headline indices climb.

Jeers

Indian startup funding fell 67% to just \$662 million in July, a sharp reversal after June's surge, with both large rounds and overall deal count scarce — a sobering data point for anyone hoping the funding winter was fully behind us.

Person/Story of the Week: Prashant Kishor

Prashant Kishor's Jan Suraa party broke through in Bihar this week, with its founder winning the Bankipur bypoll by roughly 19,000 votes — snapping a BJP stronghold and giving the poll strategist-turned-politician his party's first electoral victory. It's a small win in seat count but a large one in narrative terms, arriving just ahead of the 2027 UP polls cycle and giving Kishor's outsider project its first real proof of concept at the ballot box.

The Lighter Side

Fresh off her maiden BWF Super 300 title in Taipei, 17-year-old Tanvi Sharma heads into the Korea Masters as the face of India's badminton challenge this week — a reminder that while Glasgow 2026 just wrapped with India's 39-medal campaign, the next generation is already stacking up moments of its own.

The Week in Numbers

Index / Asset	Level	Weekly Change
Sensex	78,581	+2.68%
Nifty 50	24,624	+2.59%
Gold (24K, Rs/10g)	Rs. 1,43,900	Little changed, holding near record highs
Silver (Rs/kg)	Rs. 2,34,900	Softer after a strong run

USD/INR	95.16	Rangebound, 94.89–95.84
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Levels as of market close, August 5, 2026. Source: The Financial Buddy market data.

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